

Nat Burr

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Summary

I'm training to be an understory forest ecologist and practicing forester, with a focus on evolutionary genetics and temperate agroforestry systems in the Northeast. My experience in environmental justice law and community food systems informs my work through an emphasis on place-based interactions between people, plants, and their shared environments.

Education

Yale School of the Environment, The Forest School, New Haven, CT

Master of Forestry Candidate (Sep 2024–Dec 2026)

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI

Bachelor of Arts, Environmental Law & Policy Major, History Minor (Aug 2015–May 2019)

Thesis: The Post-Cold War Commons: How Lessons from the Past and Present Inform the Future Arctic

Research

Genomic variation in populations of wild American ginseng across New England: mapping the genome of a rare native forest understory plant

Lead Researcher, Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Jan 2025–Dec 2026)

Fellowships:

- Oak Spring Garden Foundation Interdisciplinary Residency & Fellowship (2026)
- Taylor Research Fellowship (2025)
- Williams Internship Award (2025)

Expanding guidance for site selection for forest farming crops in New England

Researcher & Project Coordinator, Northeast Forest Farmers Coalition, Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Mar 2025–Feb 2028)

A three-pronged strategy to equitably provide planting stock to forest farmers: Propagation training, seed exchange, and working with wild harvesters

Research Assistant & Project Coordinator, Northeast Forest Farmers Coalition, The Forest School at Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Jun 2024–Nov 2026)

The Northeast Forest Farmers Coalition: Building a community of practice

Research Assistant, Northeast Forest Farmers Coalition, The Forest School at Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Jun 2024–Nov 2025)

***The Appalachian Trail: A Biography* (Philip D'Anieri, Mariner Books 2021)**

Research Assistant, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI; GA to ME (Jan 2017–Nov 2017)

Professional experience

Teaching Fellow

The Practice of Silviculture: Principles in Applied Forest Ecology, Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Jan 2026–present)

Program Manager

Northeast Forest Farmers Coalition, Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Sep 2024–present)

Assistant Forest Manager in Agroforestry

Yale Forests, Yale-Myers Forest Camp, Eastford, CT (Sep 2024–present)

Student Lead

Forestry Learning Community, Yale School of the Environment, New Haven, CT (Apr 2025–present)

Co-Lead & Social Chair

Society of American Foresters, Yale Student Chapter, New Haven, CT (Apr 2025–present)

Senior Regional Manager

GrowNYC Compost Program, New York, NY (Nov 2022–June 2024)

Senior Litigation Assistant

Earthjustice, Northeast Office, Toxic Exposure & Health Program, New York, NY (Sep 2019–July 2021)

Backcountry Site Caretaker

Appalachian Mountain Club, Shelters Program, Pinkham Notch, NH (May 2019–Sep 2019, Sep–Nov 2022)

Assistant Director & Trips Program Director

Pine Island Camp for Boys, Belgrade Lakes, ME (Aug–Nov 2021, Apr 2022–Nov 2022)

Presentations & events

Understanding our roots: Phylogeny of American ginseng towards restoring valuable understory species in northeastern forests, Society of American Foresters National Convention, Hartford, CT

Presenter (Oct 2025)

Forest farming in the Northeast: People, policy, and practice, Society of American Foresters National Convention, Hartford, CT

Panelist (Oct 2025)

Xenoperspectives: Other ecologies in three films, NOoSPHERE Arts, Brooklyn, NY

Event Producer (Aug 2025)

Caliochory: Poetry, movement, and music at Marsh Botanical Garden, New Haven, CT

Event Producer (Apr 2025)

Mimic: Ecology, science & interspecies connection in film, NOoSPHERE Arts, Brooklyn, NY

Event Producer (Oct 2024)

Northeast Forest Farming Conference, Smokey House Center, Danby, VT

Event Producer & Presenter (Sept 2024)

ROTFFEST: Spring Compost Festival & Fundraiser, BK ROT, Brooklyn, NY

Event Producer (May 2024)

Dinner Is on Tuesday, Brooklyn, NY

Founder, free weekly dinners supporting fundraisers and community causes (Aug 2023–June 2024)